Group Assignment - Interaction Design Iteration

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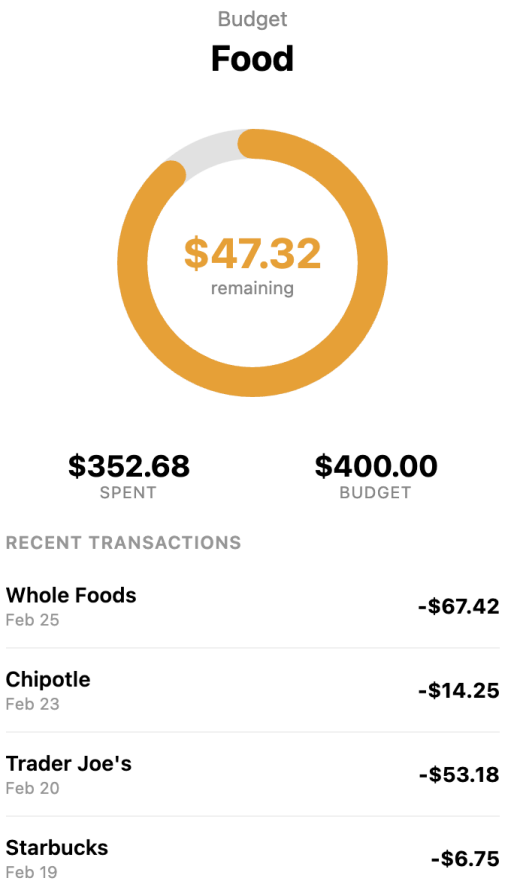
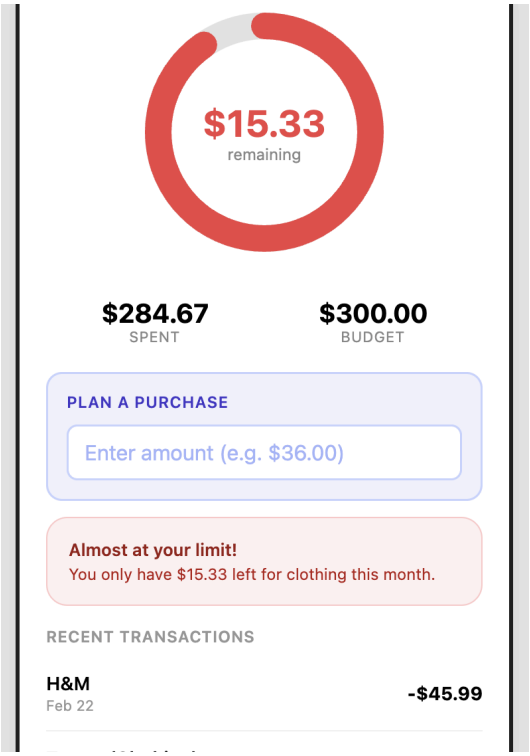
Before url: https://laws-smith-luna.github.io/User-Interface-Design/before/
After url: https://laws-smith-luna.github.io/User-Interface-Design/after/

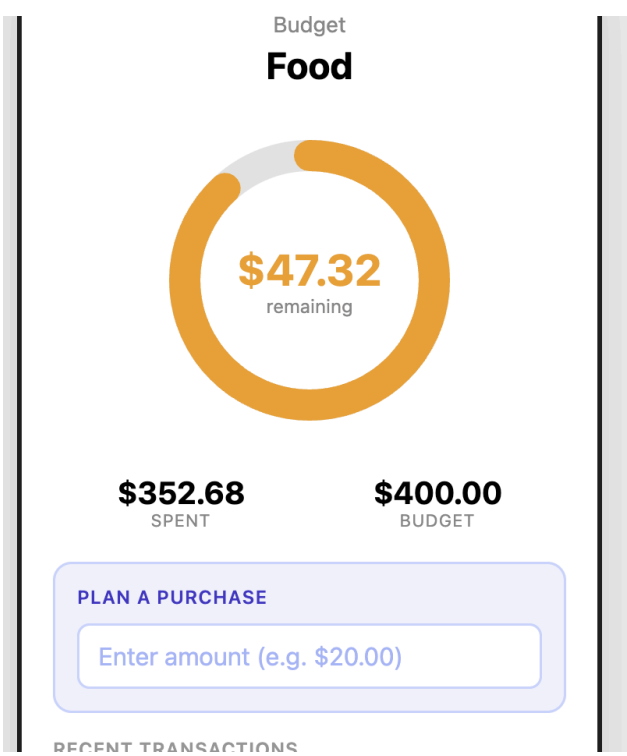
Usability Issue #1: No way to preview how a purchase would affect a budget

Description: Users lack visibility into how their spending decisions impact their budget in real time. Because budgets are only updated after purchases are made, users cannot accurately gauge affordability, especially when making multiple purchases at once. Budgeting should instead help users understand how much they can spend before committing to a transaction.
Screenshot of the issue:



Screenshots of the fixes:



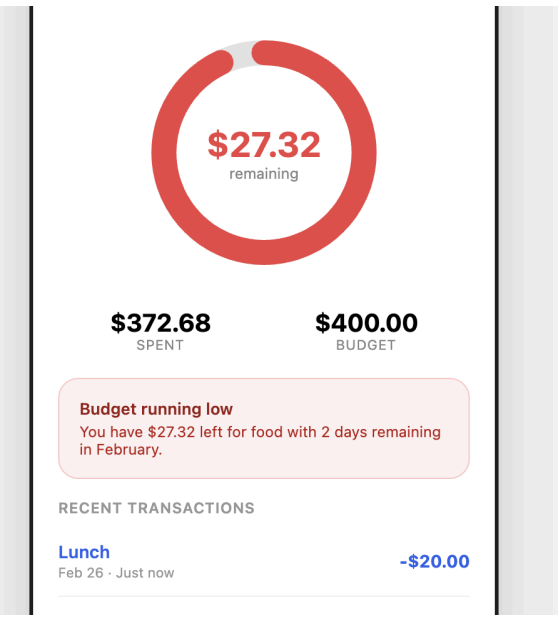


How the issue has been fixed:
The issue was resolved by allowing users to simulate purchases within their budget before actually completing them. Instead of waiting until after a transaction is completed, users can now add potential purchases and immediately see how those decisions would affect their remaining budget. This gives users immediate feedback on how purchases will impact their remaining budget, allowing them to plan ahead. This feature is especially useful when considering multiple purchases since users can see the combined impact of all the purchases instead of each purchase individually.

Usability Issue #2 Transaction labels are too vague to verify purchases
Description: The use of generic transaction labels, such as “Lunch,” significantly hinders a users ability to verify and reconcile their spending accurately against real-world activity. While the interface successfully pulls specific merchant names for some entries, such as “Whole Foods,” and “H&M” the inclusion of vague category-style labels creates an inconsistent

experience that forces users to rely purely on the transaction amount and date to identify their purchases.

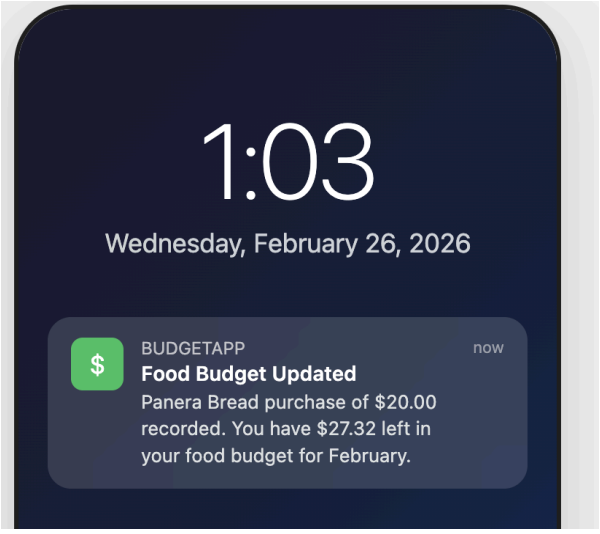
Screenshot of the issue:

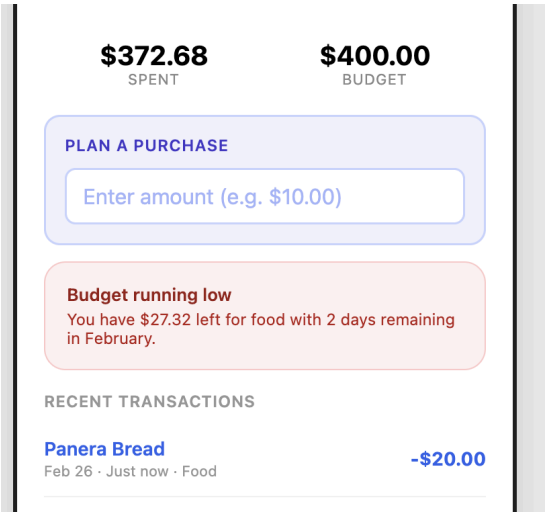


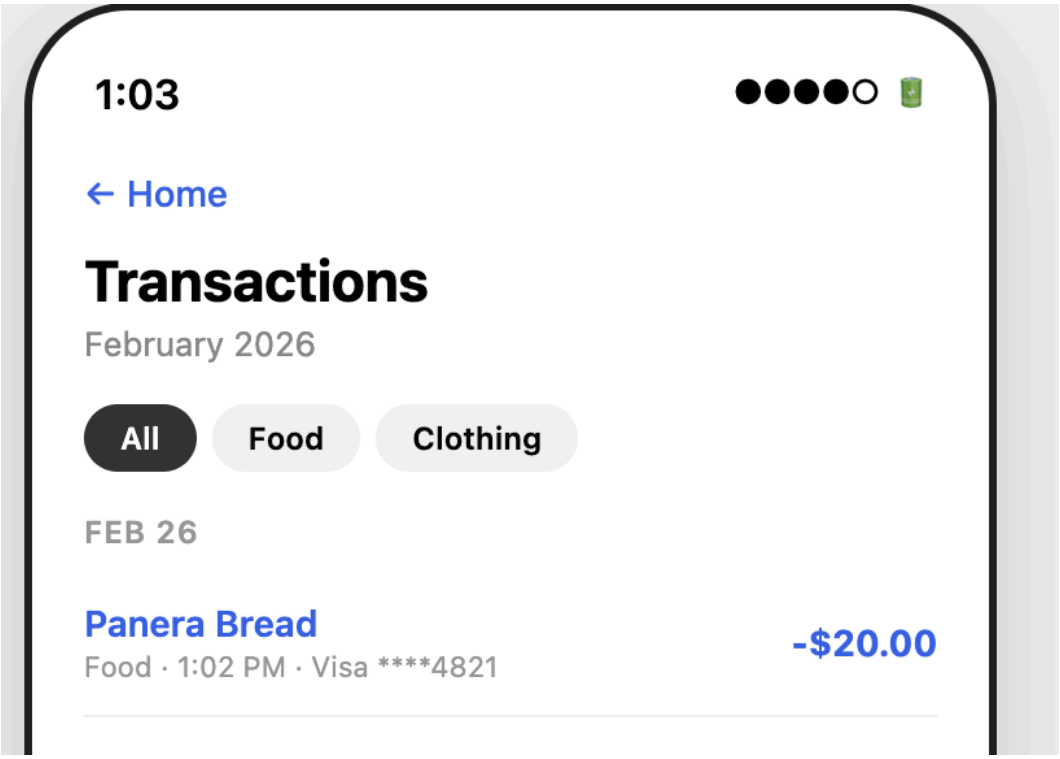
How the issue has been fixed:

This issue was addressed by improving the consistency and specificity of transaction labels across the app. Instead of displaying vague, category-based labels like “Lunch,” the updated design prioritizes merchant-specific names (e.g., Chipotle, Starbucks, Trader Joe’s). When a merchant name is unavailable, the system now supplements the label with additional contextual details, such as category, time, or location, to make the transaction easier to recognize. This ensures that users can quickly verify purchases without relying solely on memory, improving clarity, trust, and usability.

Screenshots of the fixes:



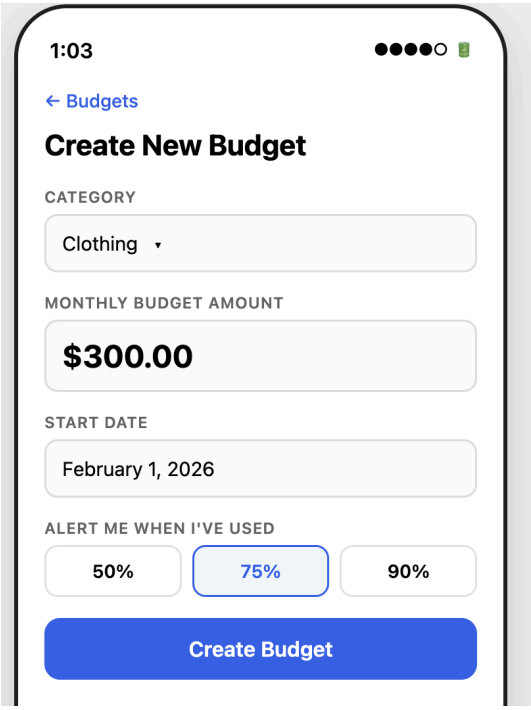


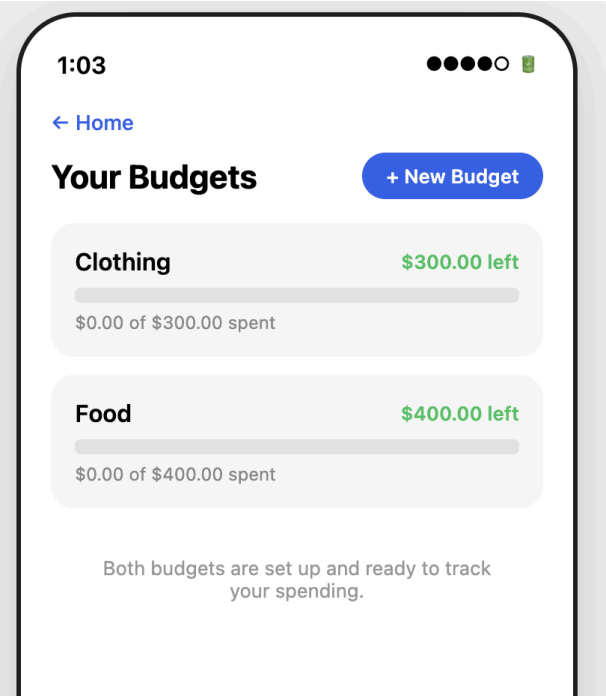


Usability Issue #3 Budget Create flow lacks clarity and guidance.
Description: The budget creation flow lacks clarity and contextual guidance at several key points, causing confusion for three out of four participants during setup. When selecting an alert threshold, the options (50%, 75%, 90%) are presented without any explanation of what the numbers represent, leaving users unsure whether the percentage refers to the amount spent or the amount remaining. One participant paused for 15 seconds and asked "75% of what exactly?" before guessing and moving on. Additionally, the "New Budget" button changes from a large, prominent call-to-action on the confirmation screen to a small pill

button in the top corner of the budget list, making it difficult for users to find when creating a second budget. Pre-filled form values, like the $300 budget amount, also caused hesitation because users couldn't tell if the value was a system suggestion or something they needed to change.

Screenshots of the issues:





How the issue has been fixed:

This issue was addressed with three changes to the budget creation flow. First, the alert threshold options now display the corresponding dollar amount beneath each percentage (e.g., "$225.00" under 75%), and a plain-language explanation updates dynamically to show exactly when the alert will trigger: "You'll get a notification when you've spent $225.00 of your $300.00 budget, with $75.00 remaining." The label was also changed to "Alert me when I've spent" with "spent" underlined for emphasis, removing the ambiguity about whether the percentage refers to spending or remaining balance. Second, the small "+ New Budget" pill button on the budget list page was replaced with a full-width primary button matching the visual weight of buttons on other screens, so users can easily find it when creating additional budgets. Third, a hint was added below the budget amount field ("Enter the amount you want to spend per month in this category") to clarify that the value is user-editable, not a system default.

Screenshots of the fixes:

category.

START DATE

February 1, 2026

ALERT ME WHEN I'VE SPENT

50%	75%	90%
$150.00	$225.00	$270.00

You'll get a notification when you've **spent $225.00** of your $300.00 budget, with **$75.00 remaining**.

Create Budget

Budget Created!

Your "Clothing" budget is set up.
$300.00 per month starting February 1.
You'll be alerted when you've spent 75% ($225.00).

BUDGET SUMMARY

Category	**Clothing**
Monthly Amount	**$300.00**
Alert Threshold	**75% spent ($225.00)**
Starts	**February 1, 2026**

Create Another Budget

1:03

← Home

Your Budgets

Clothing $300.00 left

$0.00 of $300.00 spent

Food $400.00 left

$0.00 of $400.00 spent

+ Create New Budget